Short horticulture knowledge card

White standard edition

Horticulture: soil, seeds & planting.

What soil contains

Soil usually contains mineral pieces, organic matter, water, air and living things. Air and water fill spaces between particles. A prepared growing medium is a mixture for growing plants in containers; it is not identical to natural soil.

What a hand and sight check can tell us

Look at colour, lumps and visible pieces. A lightly damp sample may feel gritty, smooth, crumbly or sticky. Sand-rich soil may feel gritty; damp clay-rich soil may feel sticky and hold a shape. These are texture clues, not a test of nutrients or safety.

Our growing choice

For the indoor pea observation tray, use the adult-approved fresh peat-free multipurpose growing medium. It must suit the seed instructions and allow excess water to drain. A known supply is not sterile. Hygiene still matters.